

— QUIET EYE TRAINING FOR GOLF

THE GOLFER'S FOCUS ADVANTAGE

Build a repeatable visual focus system — and keep it when the noise, the crowd and the consequences arrive.



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SEE. SET. QUIET. GO.

CONTENTS

WHAT'S INSIDE

This is a training manual, not an article. Read Section 01 once. Then work Sections 02 to 04 on a putting green with a scorecard in your pocket.

HOW TO USE IT

- Print pages 32–34. They are the working documents.
- Train the routine before you train the distractions.
- Score every session. Untracked practice drifts.
- Do not skip a rung of the ladder because it feels easy.

A NOTE ON EVIDENCE

Every research claim in this guide is sourced and referenced on page 38. Where the evidence is strong, we say so. Where it is preliminary or contested, we say that too.

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43%

OF THE VARIANCE IN PUTTING ERROR PREDICTED BY QUIET EYE DURATION IN ONE ELITE-GOLFER TRIAL

1.9

FEWER PUTTS PER ROUND ON COURSE AFTER QUIET EYE TRAINING IN THAT SAME TRIAL

Vine, Moore & Wilson (2011), n = 22 elite male golfers. See page 06 for what these numbers do and do not show.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Competitive amateurs, junior and collegiate players, professionals, and the coaches and parents working alongside them. No eye-tracking equipment required — a putting surface, a partner and a pen will do.



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01

UNDER STAND

The science of Quiet Eye — what your eyes are doing in the last two seconds before the stroke, and why that window decides so much.

- 04 Why focus breaks down
- 05 What Quiet Eye actually is
- 06 Why it matters in golf: the evidence
- 07 Focus isn't the absence of distraction

THE PROBLEM

WHY FOCUS BREAKS DOWN

You have hit that putt a thousand times. On Tuesday it drops without a thought. On Sunday, with the match on it, the same stroke feels borrowed. Your technique did not change overnight. **Where your attention went did.**

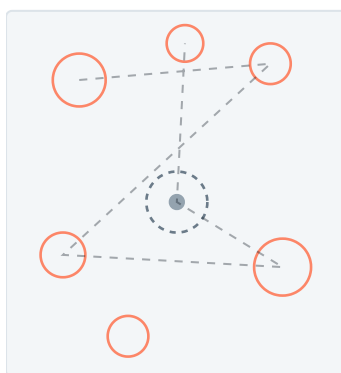
Two systems, competing for the same eyes

Visual attention is broadly governed by two networks. A **goal-directed** system points your eyes at what the task requires. A **stimulus-driven** system interrupts — it exists to catch movement, noise and anything that looks like a threat (Corbetta & Shulman, 2002).

Attentional Control Theory proposes that anxiety tips the balance toward the interrupting system. Anxious performers become more distractible and more likely to be pulled by salient cues at the expense of what they intended to look at (Eysenck et al., 2007).

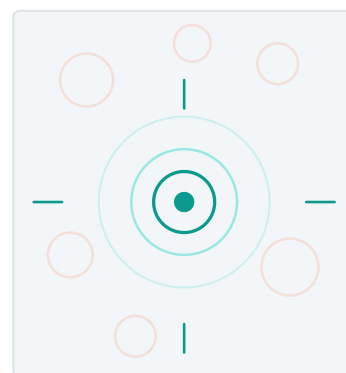
That is the whole problem in one sentence. Under pressure, **your eyes stop taking orders.**

UNDER PRESSURE



GAZE JUMPS • CUES COMPETE
SHORT FINAL FIXATION

UNDER CONTROL



GAZE SETTLES • ONE TARGET WINS
LONG, STABLE FINAL FIXATION

WHERE FOCUS LEAKS

Consequences start to matter	People are watching you
The environment gets loud	Something moves in your periphery
You start thinking about mechanics	A negative thought arrives uninvited

Notice what these have in common: not one of them is a swing fault. They are all **attention events** — and attention is trainable.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

In a study of 22 elite male golfers (mean handicap 2.8), a laboratory pressure test produced a clear split. Golfers who had received Quiet Eye training held their final fixation at roughly **2.8 seconds** and holed **60%** of 10-foot putts. The untrained control group's final fixation collapsed to about **1.4 seconds** and they holed **36%**. Both groups reported the same level of anxiety — only their gaze behaved differently.

Vine, Moore & Wilson (2011). Small, all-male, elite sample — see p.06.

THE TRAINABLE PART

**You cannot remove the interruptions.
You can rehearse the return.**

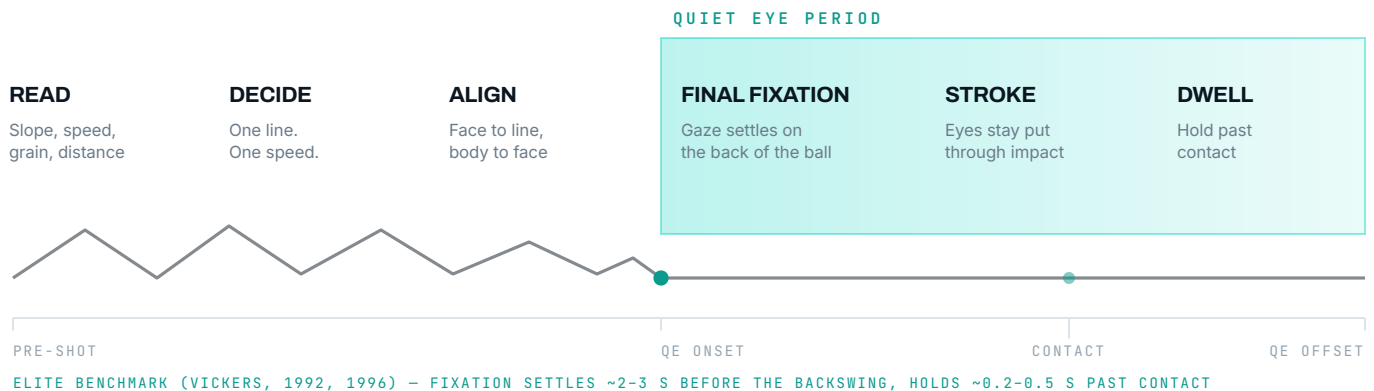
Section 02 builds that return into a routine. Section 03 gives you a ladder of interruptions to practise it against.

DEFINITION

WHAT IS QUIET EYE?

Quiet Eye is the **final, stable fixation on a task-relevant target** that begins just before you start the movement and holds through execution. In putting, that target is the ball. The stroke starts while your eyes are already still.

THE QUIET EYE TIMELINE – A 10-FOOT PUTT



WHAT IT IS

- A period long enough to finish planning the stroke before it starts
- A single, external, task-relevant point of contact for your attention
- A filter that reduces how much irrelevant information gets in
- A stable reference the motor system can guide the stroke against

WHAT IT IS NOT

- Staring harder. Effort is not the mechanism — stillness and stability are
- Freezing. Your body should feel ready, not locked
- An excuse to slow down. A long routine is not a long Quiet Eye
- A guarantee. It improves the odds; it does not remove them

WHY STILLNESS ITSELF SEEMS TO MATTER

In a virtual-reality putting experiment, researchers covertly made the fixation point drift so that gaze technically stayed on the ball but was no longer *still*. Visual information was identical across conditions, yet the "noisy eye" group putted measurably worse (mean error 105 cm vs 89 cm). The authors concluded that the stability of the fixation confers a benefit beyond simply gathering visual information — one reason "just stare at it" is the wrong coaching cue. Harris, Wilson & Vine (2023), novice golfers in VR.

THE EVIDENCE

WHY IT MATTERS IN GOLF

Quiet Eye is one of the better-supported findings in sports vision. It is also frequently oversold. Here is what the research actually establishes — and where it stops.

WHAT THE RESEARCH DEMONSTRATES

EXPERTISE

$d = 1.04$

A large pooled difference between experts' and novices' Quiet Eye durations across 27 studies. Within individuals, successful attempts showed longer Quiet Eye than unsuccessful ones ($d = 0.58$).

Lebeau et al. (2016), meta-analysis

TRAINABILITY

$d = 1.53$

Across nine intervention studies, Quiet Eye training produced very large changes in gaze behaviour and large improvements in performance ($d = 0.84$). Gaze is not fixed — it responds to instruction.

Lebeau et al. (2016), meta-analysis

TRANSFER

-1.9 PUTTS

Elite golfers given a single Quiet Eye training session reduced putts per round by 1.92 across ten subsequent competitive rounds and holed 5% more from 6–10 ft. The control group did not change.

Vine, Moore & Wilson (2011)

IT HOLDS UP UNDER PRESSURE

Quiet Eye's most useful property is resilience. Trained golfers maintained their fixation duration when anxiety was experimentally raised; untrained golfers did not, and their putting fell with it. In a separate study, Quiet Eye training also produced lower clubhead acceleration, greater heart-rate deceleration and reduced forearm muscle activity than technical instruction — physiological signatures of a calmer, better programmed stroke. Vine & Wilson (2010); Moore et al. (2012).

AND UNDER DISTRACTION

Eight Division-I collegiate golfers hit 100 putts while a camera flash fired during their Quiet Eye. Their fixations got *longer* on distracted trials, and their putting performance did not significantly drop. The authors' interpretation: skilled players may extend Quiet Eye as a coping response. Distraction did not beat them — but the sample was very small. Fulton et al. (2014).

WHERE THE EVIDENCE STOPS

Honest coaching means naming the limits. Read every claim on this page with these attached.

None of this makes Quiet Eye training a bad bet. It makes it a **well-supported, low-cost, low-risk intervention** — which is exactly how you should treat it.

- **Small samples.** The elite-golfer transfer study used 22 male golfers; the distraction study used 8. These are suggestive, not definitive.
- **Mostly putting, mostly men.** Golf Quiet Eye evidence is heavily concentrated on the putting stroke and on male participants.
- **The mechanism is contested.** Response programming, movement inhibition and attentional control are all live explanations, and one VR study found that directly manipulating Quiet Eye duration and location had little effect on novices' accuracy (Harris et al., 2021).
- **Expectancy effects are possible.** The authors of the elite-golfer study explicitly flagged that being told you are receiving expert instruction may itself help.

FOCUS ISN'T THE ABSENCE OF DISTRACTION.

Elite focus is not a quiet room. It is the ability to notice an interruption, return your eyes to the right target, and execute anyway.

Which means the skill you actually need is **recovery** — and recovery only improves if you practise being interrupted.

THE ATTENTION FUNNEL



SEE. SET. QUIET. GO.

02

TRAIN

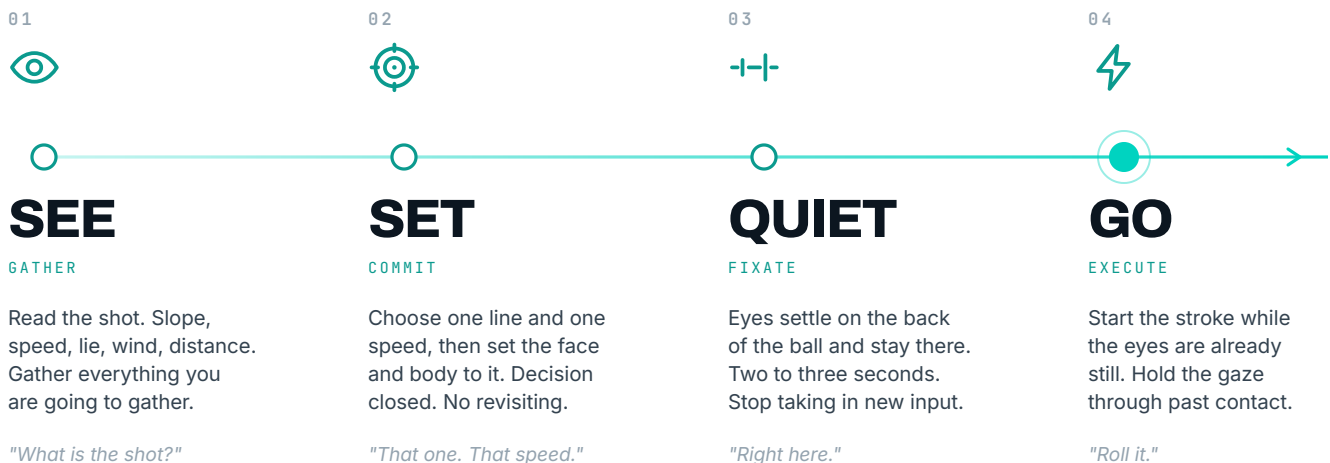
A visual routine is only useful if it survives contact with a golf course. This is the version built to be repeated — four moves, one cue, every shot.

- 09 The SEE · SET · QUIET · GO framework
- 10 The routine, step by step
- 11 Five faults that shorten your Quiet Eye
- 12 Beyond the putter: short game and full swing
- 13 Your 10-minute Quiet Eye practice

THE FRAMEWORK

SEE. SET. QUIET. GO.

Four moves. Each one closes something down so the next can happen. By the time you reach **GO**, there is nothing left to decide — which is the entire point.



THE CUE

SEE IT. SET IT. QUIET. GO.

Four words, said internally, at the same tempo every time. The words are a metronome for your attention — not a technical instruction.

✓ COACHING CUE

The transition that matters most is **SET** → **QUIET**. That is the moment you stop being an analyst and become an athlete. Most golfers never make it cleanly: they keep analysing right up to the takeaway, which is why the fixation never settles.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Turning **SEE** into a ritual. Reading a putt from four sides, plumb-bobbing and taking six practice strokes is not a longer **SEE** — it is an unfinished one. If you are still gathering after you have addressed the ball, the routine has already failed.

⌚ TRY THIS

Have someone time your routine from the moment you take your stance to the moment the putter moves. Elite pre-shot routines are notable for being **consistent**, not for being long. Aim for a variation of under one second across ten putts.

EXECUTION

THE ROUTINE, STEP BY STEP

Four questions every golfer should be able to answer without thinking:
where do I look, when do I look there, when do I stop thinking, and when do I start the stroke?

STAGE	WHAT YOU DO	WHERE YOUR EYES ARE	DURATION	WHAT ENDS IT
SEE	Read slope, speed, grain and distance from behind the ball. Pick the apex.	Moving freely — green, hole, apex, ball. Information gathering is <i>supposed</i> to be busy here.	10-20 s	You can describe the putt in one sentence: one line, one speed.
SET	Aim the face down the chosen line, then build your stance to the face.	Alternating between ball and target to confirm the line. No more than three looks to the hole.	4-7 s	Your last look leaves the hole and returns to the ball. That look does not come back.
QUIET	Nothing. Deliberately. The stroke is already programmed.	Fixed on the back of the ball, within roughly a coin's width. Still, not strained.	2-3 s	Nothing ends it — the backswing begins <i>underneath</i> it.
GO	Stroke. React to nothing.	Still on the ball through impact, then holding the spot where the ball was.	~1 s + 0.2-0.5 s	The ball is gone and your eyes have caught up to it.

THE FIVE INSTRUCTIONS THAT WERE ACTUALLY TESTED

The elite-golfer training study did not use vague advice. Golfers were given five specific gaze instructions, adapted from Vickers (2007). This is the closest thing the literature has to a protocol — use it verbatim.

- 01 Take your stance and align the club with your gaze on the back of the ball.
- 02 Once set over the ball, fix your gaze on the hole — **no more than three times**.
- 03 Your final fixation is the Quiet Eye on the back of the ball. It begins **before** the stroke and lasts two to three seconds.
- 04 No looking at the clubhead during the backswing or the forward swing.
- 05 Hold the gaze on the green for roughly **0.2-0.3 seconds** after the club contacts the ball.

Instruction set as used in Vine, Moore & Wilson (2011), adapted from Vickers (2007).

🔗 WHY "STOP ADDING INFORMATION" MATTERS

Every extra look at the hole after you have decided is a chance to change your mind. Late doubt does not produce a better read — it produces a shorter fixation and a decelerating stroke. The three-look limit exists to protect the decision you already made.

🕒 THE COMMITMENT TEST

If, standing over the ball, you could not say out loud "*left edge, firm*" — step away. Restarting the routine costs you eight seconds. Hitting an uncommitted putt costs you the hole.

📌 MAKE THE DWELL VISIBLE

After each putt, keep your eyes on the spot where the ball was and listen for it to drop. If you hear the result before you see it, your Quiet Eye held.

DIAGNOSTICS

FIVE FAULTS THAT SHORTEN YOUR QUIET EYE

Almost nobody loses their Quiet Eye by deciding to. It gets eaten by habits that look like diligence. Find yours here before you start loading distractions on top of it.

01 The fourth look

You check the hole once more just before the takeaway. The fixation resets to near zero and the stroke starts from an unsettled eye. **Fix:** cap it at three, and make the third one the last.

02 Watching the putter

Gaze drops to the clubhead during the takeaway. Less-skilled golfers do this reliably; skilled golfers do it when they are anxious. **Fix:** pick a single dimple or logo mark and own it.

03 Chasing the ball

Your eyes leave early to see the result. The head follows, the shoulders follow, the face opens. **Fix:** train the dwell deliberately — listen, don't look.

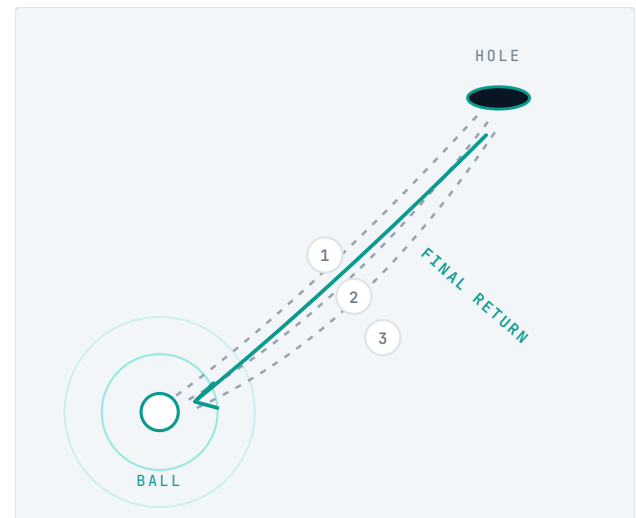
04 Thinking during QUIET

The eyes are still but the mind is running a swing checklist. This is the hardest fault to spot from outside and the most common under pressure. **Fix:** one external cue word only.

05 The stretched routine

Under pressure the whole routine slows down but the fixation does not get longer. More time, same short Quiet Eye, more room for doubt. **Fix:** time it. Consistency beats duration.

THE THREE-LOOK LIMIT



RESEARCH INSIGHT

Quiet Eye also appears to help golfers *recover from a bad putt*. In one study, longer Quiet Eye durations on the attempt following an error were associated with better subsequent performance, suggesting the fixation supports error correction rather than just initial planning. Walters-Symons, Wilson & Vine (2017).

Fix the fault before you add the load.



Adding distraction to a broken routine does not build resilience — it rehearses the fault under stress. Score a clean Level 1 session first (page 13), then climb.

TRANSFER

BEYOND THE PUTTER

Quiet Eye research in golf is overwhelmingly putting research. That is worth saying plainly before adapting it. What generalises well is the **attentional principle**; what does not generalise is the specific two-to-three second prescription.

HOW STRONG IS THE EVIDENCE, BY SHOT TYPE?

PUTTING

DIRECT EVIDENCE

Controlled trials in novice, sub-elite and elite golfers, plus measured transfer to competitive rounds. Use the full protocol on page 10 exactly as written — the ball is the fixation point, two to three seconds, held past contact.

CHIP · PITCH · BUNKER

INDIRECT SUPPORT

No comparable Quiet Eye trials. However, in 33 skilled male golfers hitting pitch shots, a **distal external focus** (the target) produced the most accurate shots and an internal focus the least — in both neutral and anxiety conditions (Bell & Hardy, 2009). Adapt the principle: keep the fixation external, keep it stable, keep the decision closed.

FULL SWING

PRINCIPLE ONLY

Quiet Eye is not established for the full swing, and we will not pretend otherwise. What *is* supported is that external-focus instructions improve golf shot accuracy in beginners and experts alike (Wulf & Su, 2007). Treat the framework as a structure for commitment and attention, not as a gaze prescription.

ADAPTING SEE · SET · QUIET · GO

SHOT	SEE	SET	QUIET	GO
CHIP / PITCH	Lie, landing spot, roll-out, carry.	Face and body to the landing spot, not the flag.	Fixation on the back of the ball or the exact contact point on the turf.	Swing to the landing spot. Hold the gaze past impact.
BUNKER	Lie, sand texture, distance, height needed.	Face open, feet set, entry point chosen.	Fixation on the entry point in the sand , not the ball.	Swing through the entry point. Eyes stay in the sand.
TEE / APPROACH	Wind, lie, number, shape, the miss you can live with.	Intermediate target a few feet ahead, face to it, body to face.	Final look leaves the target and settles on the ball. Roughly one to two seconds.	Start the swing on a still eye. One external cue only.

DO THIS TODAY

YOUR 10-MINUTE QUIET EYE PRACTICE

One putting surface. One ball. Ten minutes. This is the session you repeat until the routine is automatic — and the baseline everything in Section 03 is loaded on top of.

CALIBRATE

0-2 MIN

3 ft · no target

BUILD

2-5 MIN

6 ft · routine reps

HOLD

5-8 MIN

10 ft · full routine

TEST

8-10 MIN

10 ft · scored, one ball

01 CALIBRATE

2 MIN · 10 STROKES · 3 FT

Putt to nothing. No hole, no target, no result. Your only job is to feel the fixation settle before the putter moves and stay after contact. Count "one-thousand-one, one-thousand-two" silently before every takeaway.

MEASURE: DID THE EYE
SETTLE FIRST? Y/N

02 BUILD

3 MIN · 12 PUTTS · 6 FT

Full routine every ball, including walking in from behind. Three looks maximum. Say the four cue words internally at the same tempo. Do not chase makes — you are rehearsing a sequence, not scoring.

MEASURE: ROUTINE
COMPLETED 12/12?

03 HOLD

3 MIN · 10 PUTTS · 10 FT

Same routine, longer putt, harder read. Add the dwell: after contact, keep your eyes on the spot and let your ears tell you the result. If you look up early, that rep does not count.

MEASURE: DWELL HELD
10/10?

04 TEST

2 MIN · 10 PUTTS · 10 FT

One ball, walk to it each time, score it. Record makes and average distance from the hole on misses. Then rate your focus 1-10. This number is your Level 1 baseline for the Distraction Ladder.

MEASURE: MAKES · ERROR
· FOCUS 1-10

✓ PROGRESSION CRITERIA

Repeat this session until you can complete the routine on **10 out of 10** putts in block 04, with a focus score of **8 or higher**, on two consecutive days. Only then start Level 2 of the ladder. Most golfers need three to five sessions.

👁️ NEUROVISION EDGE

Quiet Eye is one visual skill among several that separate good players from elite ones — alongside tracking, depth judgement, peripheral awareness and reaction speed. Measuring those is what a structured visual-performance program is for.

03

LOAD

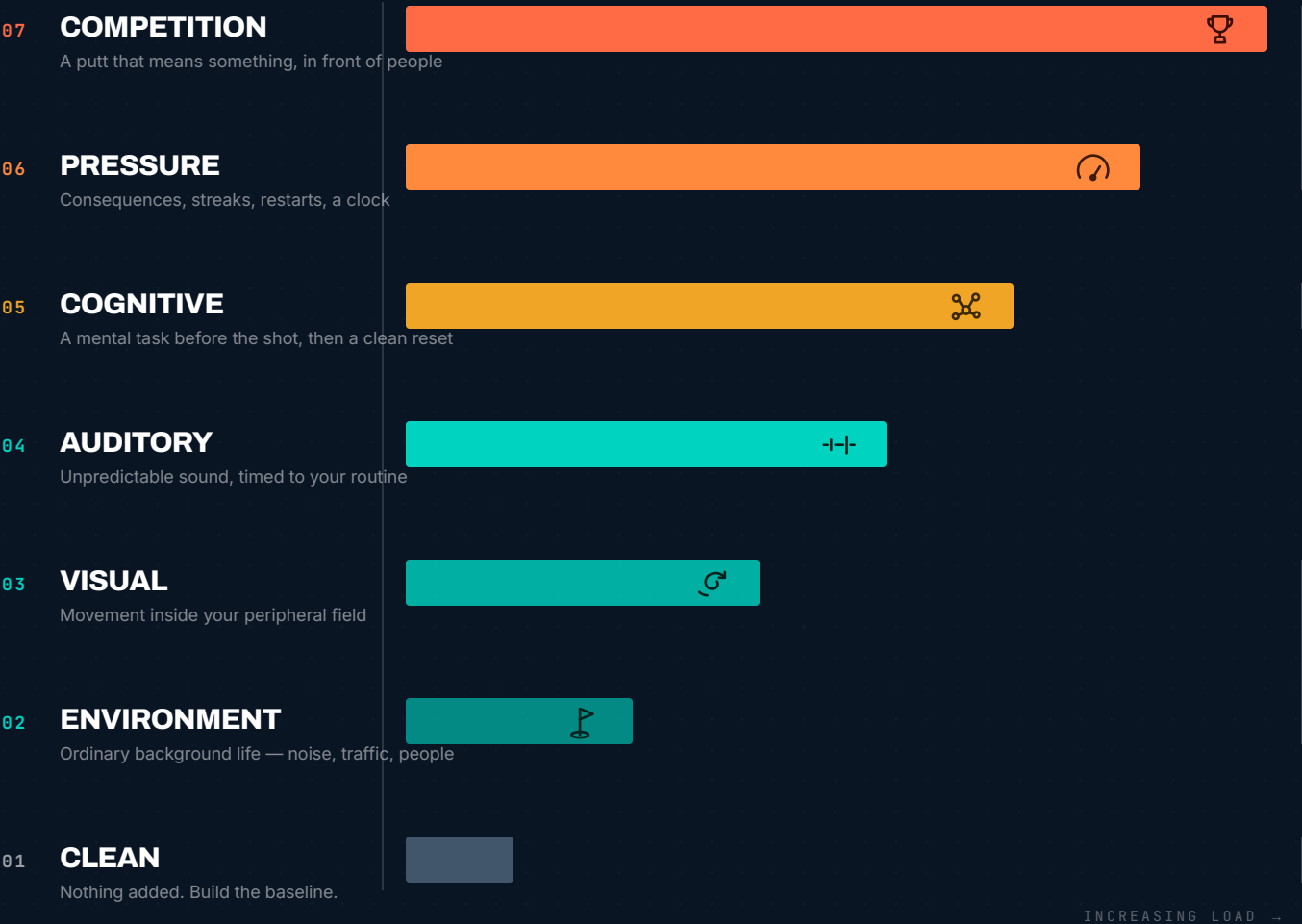
Do not wait for a tournament to find out whether your focus survives interruption. Build the interruption into practice, one graded level at a time.

- 15 The Distraction Ladder
- 16 Levels 01–02 · Clean and Environment
- 17 Levels 03–04 · Visual and Auditory
- 18 Level 05 · Cognitive load
- 19 Levels 06–07 · Pressure and Competition
- 20 The rules of loading & the Focus Stability Score

THE SYSTEM

THE DISTRACTION LADDER

Seven levels of load. You do not skip rungs and you do not randomise them. Each level has an entry standard, a way to run it and a way to score it — and you only climb when the level below is boringly reliable.



BAR LENGTH INDICATES RELATIVE ATTENTIONAL LOAD — NOT THE DIFFICULTY OF THE PUTT ITSELF

01 • CONTROL

Your reference session. Everything above is measured against this number.

02-04 • EXTERNAL LOAD

The world interrupting you. Trains the eyes to stay where you sent them.

05 • INTERNAL LOAD

Your own mind interrupting you. Trains the reset, not multitasking.

06-07 • CONSEQUENCE

It matters now. Trains the routine to hold its shape when it counts.

LEVEL 01 CLEAN FOCUS



No added distraction. Quiet corner of the practice green, normal conditions, full routine every ball. This is not a warm-up — it is the measurement everything else is compared against.

HOW TO RUN IT

- 01 10 putts from 10 ft, one ball, walk in to each.
- 02 Complete SEE · SET · QUIET · GO on every single one.
- 03 Record makes, average distance from the hole on misses, and a focus score out of 10.

TRACK

Makes · error · focus 1–10
· routine completed Y/N

MOVE UP WHEN

Routine completed 10/10
and focus ≥ 8 , on two
separate days

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Treating Level 1 as the easy bit and rushing past it. If your baseline is unstable, every score above it is noise. Most golfers who plateau on this ladder never actually established a clean baseline.

LEVEL 02 ENVIRONMENTAL DISTRACTION



Ordinary background life, not staged interference. You are not trying to be startled — you are practising in a setting that has texture, so a busy first tee is not the first busy place you have ever putted.

EXAMPLES

- Practise at the busiest hour instead of the quietest
- Background conversation, carts, mowers, range noise
- Music playing at conversational volume
- People moving through your peripheral field at distance

HOW TO RUN IT

- 01 Same 10 putts, same routine, same scoring — only the setting changes.
- 02 Do not adjust your routine to "beat" the noise. Identical tempo, identical three looks.
- 03 After each miss, note in one word what pulled you, if anything did.

TRACK

Same four metrics, plus
what distracted you

MOVE UP WHEN

Focus score within 1
point of your Level 1
baseline, twice

🔗 THE PRINCIPLE BEHIND THE WHOLE LADDER

Attentional Control Theory predicts that pressure and anxiety make the stimulus-driven system more influential — you become more capturable. Deliberate exposure gives you repetitions at noticing that capture and returning, at a difficulty you choose, on a day that does not count. That is the only part of this you can actually rehearse.

LEVEL 03 VISUAL DISTRACTION



Movement inside your peripheral field while the routine runs. This is the level that most directly targets the stimulus-driven interrupt — your visual system is built to look at things that move.

EXAMPLES

- Partner steps slowly across your periphery during SET
- A brightly coloured towel or headcover waved at the edge of vision
- A second ball rolled across the green, well clear of your line
- Your own shadow or a partner's shadow crossing the ball

HOW TO RUN IT

- 01 Partner varies *when* the movement happens — sometimes during SEE, sometimes during QUIET, sometimes not at all.
- 02 Unpredictability is the training stimulus. A metronomic distraction stops being one.
- 03 If your eyes leave the ball, stop, step off and restart the routine. Do not putt anyway.

⚠ SAFETY & ETIQUETTE

Stay outside the club's arc and behind the player. Nothing thrown, nothing near the line of play. If you are on a shared practice green, do not run this — other golfers did not consent to your training. Skip strobing or flashing lights entirely if anyone present has a history of migraine or photosensitivity.

LEVEL 04 AUDITORY DISTRACTION



Sound you cannot predict, deliberately timed against your routine. The goal is not to stop hearing it. The goal is to **notice it without following it** — the noise registers, the eyes do not move.

EXAMPLES

- Partner speaks a random word mid-routine
- A phone alarm set to go off at an unknown moment
- Crowd noise or a stadium recording played on a speaker
- A club dropped or a bag zipped behind you

HOW TO RUN IT

- 01 Ten putts. The partner triggers sound on roughly half, at random points.
- 02 Escalate across sessions: predictable → unpredictable → timed inside the QUIET window.
- 03 Score recovery separately: did you continue, reset cleanly, or hit a compromised putt?

TRACK

Distracted trials vs clean trials, scored separately

MOVE UP WHEN

Distracted-trial focus score within 2 points of clean trials

🔬 RESEARCH INSIGHT

When eight Division-I collegiate golfers were hit with a camera flash during their Quiet Eye, something unexpected happened: their fixations got **longer**, and their putting did not significantly suffer. The researchers suggested skilled players may lengthen Quiet Eye as a coping response to distraction. With only eight participants this is a lead rather than a law — but it points at the right instinct. When something interrupts you, **hold the fixation longer, not shorter**. Fulton, Ertz, Rohler, Fontana & Mack (2014).

LEVEL 05

COGNITIVE LOAD

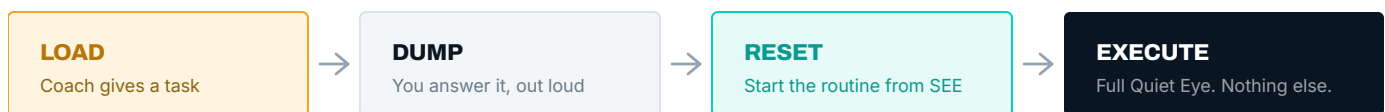
Levels 2 to 4 train you against the world. This one trains you against yourself — the arithmetic, the leaderboard maths, the swing thought that arrives uninvited on the last hole.

⚠ READ THIS BEFORE YOU RUN IT

The goal is **not** to think about two things while you stroke the putt. Dual-tasking during execution is exactly what you are trying to eliminate. The mental task goes **before** the routine. What you are rehearsing is the transition — dumping the cognitive load and arriving at QUIET with an empty head, on demand.

HOW IT WORKS

BEFORE THE ROUTINE



THE TRAINING TARGET IS THE JOINT BETWEEN "DUMP" AND "RESET" — NOT THE MENTAL TASK ITSELF

TASK MENU • START HERE

- Coach calls a three-digit number. You repeat it after the putt.
- "What was your score on the last three holes?"
- Count backwards from 40 in threes for five seconds.
- Name the last four clubs you hit, in order.

TASK MENU • HARDER

- Coach gives the number *and* changes the target hole at the same time.
- "You need this and the next one to shoot level."
- A five-item sequence to recall after the putt drops.
- A deliberately unhelpful technical comment about your stroke.

✓ WHY THIS TRANSFERS

On a golf course, the cognitive load arrives before the shot, not during it: the number you need, the group waiting, the swing tip from the range. The skill is not blocking those thoughts out — it is having a reliable route back to the ball once they have happened. You are training the route.

⌚ THE FIVE-SECOND RULE

Give yourself five seconds between the mental task and the start of SEE. Not zero — rushing the transition teaches panic. Not thirty — that is avoidance. Five seconds is roughly what you get on a real golf course between a distraction and your turn to play.

TRACK

Reset time · routine completed Y/N · focus 1–10

MOVE UP WHEN

You reset inside five seconds on 8 of 10 loaded putts

LEVEL 06 PRESSURE



Now the putt costs something. Pressure changes attention — that is the entire finding this guide rests on — so it has to be introduced in graded doses, not switched on at maximum.

GRADED DOSES • LOW TO HIGH

- Make 3 in a row to finish; miss and the count resets
- A target score you must beat to end the session
- A physical forfeit — push-ups, extra range balls, buying coffee
- Head-to-head against a partner, alternating putts
- Announce your target out loud before you start
- A clock: 20 seconds from arriving at the ball to the stroke

WHAT SHOULD NOT CHANGE

PRESSURE

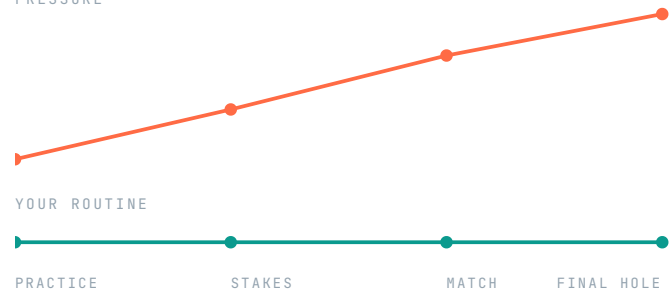
YOUR ROUTINE

PRACTICE

STAKES

MATCH

FINAL HOLE



✓ THE ONLY SCORE THAT MATTERS HERE

Not makes. **Routine consistency.** If your three looks became five and your Quiet Eye shortened, you failed the rep even if the putt dropped.

LEVEL 07 COMPETITION SIMULATION



The top rung combines everything below it: real consequence, real observers, real specificity. You name the scenario out loud before the putt so your brain has something concrete to respond to.

SCENARIOS

- "This to win the match."
- "Par putt to stay in contention."
- "18th green, one back."
- "Make this and you beat your best round."
- "Team is watching. First putt of the qualifier."

HOW TO RUN IT

- 01 One ball. One attempt. No do-overs, no "best of three".
- 02 Say the scenario aloud, then walk away for thirty seconds before you play it.
- 03 Have at least one person physically watching — teammates, a coach, a parent.
- 04 Debrief immediately: what happened to the routine, and how fast did you recover?

TRACK

Routine held Y/N · looks to hole · focus 1–10 · outcome

DO NOT

Run Level 7 more than twice a week, or on a junior athlete without a debrief

GOVERNING RULES

HOW TO CLIMB WITHOUT FALLING OFF

- 01 **One variable at a time.** Change the level or the difficulty within a level — never both in the same session.
- 02 **Master, then climb.** Meet the written criterion twice, on separate days, before you move up.
- 03 **Keep a clean block.** Every session opens with five Level 1 putts, so you always know what your baseline is doing.
- 04 **Unpredictable beats intense.** A quiet distraction you cannot time is better training than a loud one you can.
- 05 **Go back down when it breaks.** Two sessions in a row below criterion means you dropped a level, not that you need more grit.
- 06 **Cap the top end.** Levels 6 and 7 are a stimulus, not a lifestyle. Twice a week is plenty.

⚠ THE FAILURE MODE TO WATCH FOR

If a player starts dreading practice, shortening routines to get it over with, or getting visibly upset at distractions, the load is too high. Drop two levels. Resilience is built by succeeding under manageable difficulty, not by being overwhelmed repeatedly.

Progressive overload is a training principle, not a mood. These six rules are what stop "load the distractions" from becoming "make practice unpleasant and call it mental toughness".

THE FOCUS STABILITY SCORE

One number, given honestly, immediately after the session. It measures where your attention was — **not whether the putts went in.**



SCORE THESE EVERY SESSION

- 01 **Quiet Eye routine completed** — Y / N per putt
- 02 **Target commitment** — Y / N. Could you name the line out loud?
- 03 **Pre-shot consistency** — 1–10. Same shape every ball?
- 04 **Execution quality** — 1–10, independent of outcome
- 05 **Outcome** — makes, and average error on misses
- 06 **Distraction level** — which rung you were on
- 07 **Recovery time** — seconds from interruption to a clean restart

|| THE NUMBER THAT PREDICTS PROGRESS

Watch the **gap** between your clean-block focus score and your loaded-block focus score. Skill is not the loaded score going up — it is the gap closing. A player who scores 9 clean and 5 loaded is more fragile than one who scores 7 and 7.

04

PER FORM

Twelve drills, a fourteen-day program and a protocol for the moment it goes wrong. Everything from here is meant to be done, not read.

-
- 22 The drill index
 - 23 Drills 01–12
 - 29 The 14-day focus program
 - 31 When you lose focus — the reset protocol
 - 32 Printable checklist, scorecard and session log
-

THE TOOLKIT

TWELVE DRILLS

Each drill names the rung it belongs to. Work them in order the first time through — the later ones assume the routine built by the earlier ones is already automatic.

#	DRILL	LEVEL	TRAINS	PAGE
01	The Baseline Ten	L1	Your reference score and a complete routine on every ball	23
02	Ball-Back Hold	L1	Fixation duration and the dwell past contact	23
03	The Three-Look Gate	L1	Pre-shot discipline — stop gathering information	24
04	Commit or Step Off	L1-2	Target commitment and the cost of doubt	24
05	The Peripheral Mover	L3	Holding gaze against movement in the visual field	25
06	Random Word	L4	Hearing an interruption without following it	25
07	Number Load	L5	Dumping cognitive load and arriving empty at QUIET	26
08	The Interrupted Routine	L3-5	Recovery — stepping off and restarting cleanly	26
09	The Gauntlet	L6	Routine stability across a streak that can reset	27
10	Clock Putt	L6	Keeping routine shape when time is short	27
11	One Ball, One Scenario	L7	Competition simulation with observers and consequence	28
12	Landing Spot Lock	TRANSFER	Carrying the framework into the short game and full swing	28

⌚ WHAT YOU NEED

A putting surface, one ball, a putter, a pen and this book. Drills 05 to 11 need a second person. Nothing here requires eye-tracking equipment — you are training a behaviour you can observe and score without it.

✅ SESSION SHAPE

Every session, regardless of level: **five clean putts** to open (your reference block), the drill itself, then **three clean putts** to close. You always finish with the routine working.

DRILL 01 THE BASELINE TEN

LEVEL 01

OBJECTIVE	Establish the reference number every later session is compared against.
SETUP	One ball, 10 ft, straight or gently breaking putt. Quiet corner of the green.
PERFORM	Walk in from behind the ball for every putt. Full SEE · SET · QUIET · GO. Retrieve the ball yourself between reps — the walk is part of the routine.
PROGRESS	Move to 15 ft, then to a breaking putt, then to a downhill putt. Same ten reps.

TRACK

Makes /10 · average distance from hole on misses · routine completed Y/N · focus score 1–10

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Raking six balls in a row from the same spot. Repetition without the walk-in is rehearsing a stroke, not a routine — and the routine is the thing under pressure.

✅ COACHING CUE

"Same shape, every ball."

DRILL 02 BALL-BACK HOLD

LEVEL 01

OBJECTIVE	Lengthen and stabilise the final fixation, and build the dwell past contact.
SETUP	6 ft putt. Mark one dimple or the logo on the back of the ball with a dot.
PERFORM	Set up, take your three looks, return to the dot. Count "one-thousand-one, one-thousand-two" silently, then begin the backswing. Keep your eyes on the empty spot until you hear the result.
PROGRESS	Stage 1: eyes closed after contact. Stage 2: eyes open, hold the spot. Stage 3: partner calls "up" when you may look.

TRACK

Dwell held Y/N per putt (partner watches your head) · count completed before takeaway Y/N

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Straining. A hard stare tenses the neck and shoulders and shows up as a decelerating stroke. The eye should be *still*, not clamped — soft focus on a single point.

✅ COACHING CUE

"Listen for it. Don't look for it."

DRILL 03 THE THREE-LOOK GATE

LEVEL 01

OBJECTIVE	Cap information gathering so the fixation has room to settle.
SETUP	10 ft breaking putt. A partner stands square to your face, counting your looks to the hole on their fingers.
PERFORM	Play twelve putts. The partner holds up a hand the instant you take a fourth look. On a fourth look you step off and restart the whole routine — the putt does not count.
PROGRESS	Reduce the cap to two looks. Then run it on a downhill breaker where the urge to re-check is strongest.

TRACK

Looks per putt · number of restarts · which situations trigger the fourth look

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Hitting the putt anyway after the fourth look "because it was close enough". The restart is the drill. Without a consequence, the cap is a suggestion.

✅ COACHING CUE

"Last look leaves — and it doesn't come back."

DRILL 04 COMMIT OR STEP OFF

LEVEL 01-02

OBJECTIVE	Make commitment an explicit, audible gate rather than a vague feeling.
SETUP	Ten putts of varying length and break, 8–20 ft.
PERFORM	Before every putt, say the line and speed out loud in four words or fewer — "left edge, firm", "cup and a half". If you cannot say it cleanly, you step away and read it again. Only then do you address the ball.
PROGRESS	Move the commitment statement to a silent internal one. Then run it inside Level 2 background noise.

TRACK

Committed first time Y/N · step-offs · did your stroke decelerate on uncommitted putts?

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Naming a line but not a speed. Most missed putts are speed decisions, and an uncommitted speed is the fastest route to a short, tentative stroke.

✅ COACHING CUE

"Say it, or step off."

DRILL 05 THE PERIPHERAL MOVER

LEVEL 03

OBJECTIVE	Keep the fixation on the ball while something moves at the edge of vision.
SETUP	10 ft putt. Partner positioned behind and to the side , well outside the arc of the club and clear of the line of play.
PERFORM	Twelve putts. On roughly six of them — chosen at random by the partner — they step slowly across your peripheral field or wave a headcover once. Timing varies: sometimes during SET, sometimes inside QUIET.
PROGRESS	Slow walk → single fast movement → movement close to your line of sight → two movements in one routine.

TRACK

Score distracted and clean trials **separately** · eyes left the ball Y/N · focus 1–10 for each block

⚠ SAFETY

Never in front of the player, never inside the club's arc, never on a shared practice green where other golfers are trying to putt. If anyone present has a photosensitivity or migraine history, no flashing or strobing devices at all.

✓ COACHING CUE

"Let it happen in the corner of your eye."

DRILL 06 RANDOM WORD

LEVEL 04

OBJECTIVE	Register a sound without letting it move your eyes or your tempo.
SETUP	10 ft putt. Partner stands behind you with a list of unrelated words.
PERFORM	Twelve putts. On six, the partner says one word at a random point — sometimes as you address the ball, sometimes mid-QUIET. You continue. After the putt, repeat the word back, to prove you heard it and chose not to follow it.
PROGRESS	Neutral word → a word about your stroke → a phone alarm at an unknown time → recorded crowd noise on a speaker.

TRACK

Word recalled Y/N · tempo changed Y/N · distracted vs clean focus scores

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Trying not to hear it. Suppression takes attention, which is the resource you are protecting. The instruction is to notice it and keep your eyes exactly where they were.

✓ COACHING CUE

"Hear it. Don't chase it."

DRILL 07 NUMBER LOAD

LEVEL 05

OBJECTIVE	Practise dumping a mental task and arriving at QUIET with nothing left in your head.
SETUP	10 ft putt. Partner with a stopwatch.
PERFORM	Before each putt the partner gives a task — a three-digit number, a small sum, a question about your last three holes. You answer out loud , wait five seconds, then start the routine from SEE. The task never enters the routine.
PROGRESS	Longer sequences → a task plus a changed target → an unhelpful technical comment about your stroke.

TRACK

Reset time in seconds · routine completed Y/N · focus 1–10 · was the task still in your head at address?

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Holding the number through the stroke. That is dual-tasking, and it is the opposite of the goal. Answer it, let it go, then start. If you are still rehearsing it at address, stop and restart.

✅ COACHING CUE

"Answer it. Drop it. Start again."

DRILL 08 THE INTERRUPTED ROUTINE

LEVEL 03-05

OBJECTIVE	Train the recovery itself — the thing that actually separates players under pressure.
SETUP	10 ft putt. Partner calls "STOP" at unpredictable points in your routine.
PERFORM	Ten putts. On "STOP" you break off completely — step back, take one breath, and restart from SEE. No shortcuts, no picking up mid-routine. The partner times how long the full restart takes.
PROGRESS	Interrupt later and later: during SEE → during SET → mid-QUIET → during the takeaway.

TRACK

Restart time · full routine rebuilt Y/N · frustration 1–10 (lower is the goal)

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Resuming from where you were interrupted. A half-routine produces a half-fixation. The rebuild is the repetition you came for.

🔄 COACHING CUE

"Back to the start. Every time."

DRILL 09 THE GAUNTLET

LEVEL 06

OBJECTIVE	Hold routine shape as a streak builds and the cost of a miss rises.
SETUP	Six ball markers in a circle at 6 ft. One ball.
PERFORM	Make all six in a row to finish. A miss sends you back to the first marker. Full routine on every putt, including the ones late in a streak when you most want to rush.
PROGRESS	6 ft → 8 ft → 10 ft. Then add a cap: three failed attempts and the session ends unfinished.

TRACK

Attempts to complete · looks to the hole on putts 5 and 6 vs putts 1 and 2 · routine held Y/N

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Speeding up as the streak grows. Watch for the routine compressing on putt five — that is the pressure signature, and it is the whole reason this drill exists.

✓ COACHING CUE

"Putt six gets the same eight seconds as putt one."

DRILL 10 CLOCK PUTT

LEVEL 06

OBJECTIVE	Prove the routine still fits when there is less time than you would like.
SETUP	Ten putts, 10–15 ft. Partner with a visible timer.
PERFORM	Twenty seconds from arriving at the ball to the stroke. Complete the full routine inside it — read, commit, three looks, two-second fixation. Over time and the putt is void, regardless of outcome.
PROGRESS	20 s → 16 s → 14 s. Below fourteen seconds you are shortening the fixation, which is the wrong adaptation. Do not go there.

TRACK

Putts inside the limit · what got cut when you ran short · fixation held Y/N

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Cutting QUIET to save time. The fixation is the last thing you sacrifice — trim the read, trim the practice strokes, never the two seconds over the ball.

✓ COACHING CUE

"Faster to the ball. Same time over it."

DRILL 11 ONE BALL, ONE SCENARIO

LEVEL 07

OBJECTIVE	Rehearse the routine in the conditions it will actually be tested in.
SETUP	Six putts across the green at different lengths. At least one person watching.
PERFORM	Before each putt, say the scenario out loud — "this to win the match", "par putt to make the cut". Walk away for thirty seconds. Come back and play it once. No second ball, no best-of-three.
PROGRESS	One observer → a small group → teammates who react audibly → filming it.

TRACK

Routine held Y/N · looks to hole · focus 1–10 · outcome · what changed compared with a clean block

⚠ COMMON MISTAKE

Running it every session. This is a high dose. Twice a week is the ceiling, and a junior player should always get a short debrief afterwards rather than being left with the miss.

✓ COACHING CUE

"Same routine. Bigger moment."

DRILL 12 LANDING SPOT LOCK

TRANSFER

OBJECTIVE	Carry the framework out of putting and into the short game and full swing.
SETUP	Chipping green with a towel or coin as a landing spot, then a range station with an intermediate target.
PERFORM	Chips: SEE the lie and roll-out, SET face and body to the landing spot, QUIET on the exact contact point, GO through it. Full swing: pick an intermediate target a few feet ahead, set to it, let the last look leave the target and settle on the ball, then swing on a still eye.
PROGRESS	Add Level 2 background noise, then a partner calling a different landing spot right before you set up.

TRACK

Landing spot named before every shot Y/N · proximity to the spot · routine shape identical across clubs

⚠ WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS HERE

Not a Quiet Eye prescription — that evidence is putting-specific. What is supported is keeping attention *external*: in skilled golfers hitting pitch shots, a distal external focus produced the most accurate shots in both neutral and anxiety conditions (Bell & Hardy, 2009).

✓ COACHING CUE

"Name the spot. Then hit the spot."

PROGRAM

THE 14-DAY FOCUS PROGRAM

Ten to twenty minutes a day.
Deliberately modest volume — this is attentional training, and quality collapses long before your arms get tired.

DAYS 1-3		DAYS 4-7		DAYS 8-11		DAYS 12-14	
BASELINE & ROUTINE		EXTERNAL LOAD		SOUND & COGNITION		PRESSURE & TEST	
DAY	OBJECTIVE	LEVEL	DRILL	VOLUME	WHAT YOU MEASURE		
01	Baseline. Establish your reference number.	L1	01	10 min · 10 putts	Makes, error, focus 1-10. Write it down — everything is compared to this.		
02	Build the fixation. Length and stillness.	L1	02	12 min · 20 putts	Count completed before takeaway; dwell held after contact.		
03	Close the gate. Cap the information.	L1	03 + 04	15 min · 22 putts	Looks per putt, restarts, committed-first-time rate.		
04	Add the world. Same routine, busier setting.	L2	01	12 min · 15 putts	Focus score vs Day 1. Target: within 1 point.		
05	Hold the gate under noise.	L2	03 + 04	15 min · 22 putts	Looks per putt in a busy setting vs a quiet one.		
06	Movement. First deliberate interference.	L3	05	15 min · 18 putts	Distracted vs clean blocks, scored separately.		
07	Take it outside. Nine holes, routine only.	L2	—	0n course	Routine completed on every shot Y/N. Do not score your golf today.		

✓ THE DAY 7 CHECKPOINT

Before starting Day 8, your Level 1 routine should be completed on 10 of 10 putts with a focus score of 8 or better, on two separate days. If it is not, repeat Days 2 and 3 rather than pressing on. There is no benefit to loading distraction onto a routine that is still being assembled — and the whole ladder is built on the assumption that the bottom rung is solid.

DAYS 08-14 • SOUND, COGNITION, PRESSURE

DAY	OBJECTIVE	LEVEL	DRILL	VOLUME	WHAT YOU MEASURE
08	Sound. Notice it without following it.	L4	06	15 min · 18 putts	Word recalled Y/N, tempo unchanged Y/N, gap between blocks.
09	Combine. Movement and sound, unpredictably.	L3+4	05 / 06	15 min · 20 putts	Focus gap between distracted and clean blocks. Target: ≤ 2 points.
10	Cognitive load. Dump and reset.	L5	07	15 min · 16 putts	Reset time in seconds. Target: under five, on 8 of 10.
11	Recovery. The interrupt-and-rebuild rep.	L5	08	15 min · 14 putts	Full rebuild Y/N, restart time, frustration 1–10.
12	Consequence. The streak that can reset.	L6	09	15 min · variable	Looks to hole on putts 5–6 vs 1–2. Routine held Y/N.
13	Time plus load. Pressure with the clock.	L6	10 + 06	15 min · 15 putts	Putts inside the limit; what got cut when you ran short.
14	Test day. Competition, then retest baseline.	L7 → L1	11 + 01	20 min · 16 putts	Scenario block, then a clean Baseline Ten. Compare with Day 1.

READING YOUR DAY 14 RESULT

Two numbers matter, and neither of them is how many putts you holed.

01 The baseline shift

Day 14 clean block versus Day 1. A rise in routine consistency and focus score is the primary outcome. Putts holed over ten attempts is far too small a sample to tell you anything reliable.

02 The gap

Loaded focus score versus clean focus score. If that gap narrowed over fourteen days, the program worked — that gap *is* your fragility under distraction, expressed as a number.

⚠ IF A DAY GOES BADLY

One poor session is noise. Two consecutive sessions below the criterion means you drop a level and rebuild — not that you add grit. Repeating a rung is the normal path through this program, not a failure of it.

🔄 AFTER DAY 14

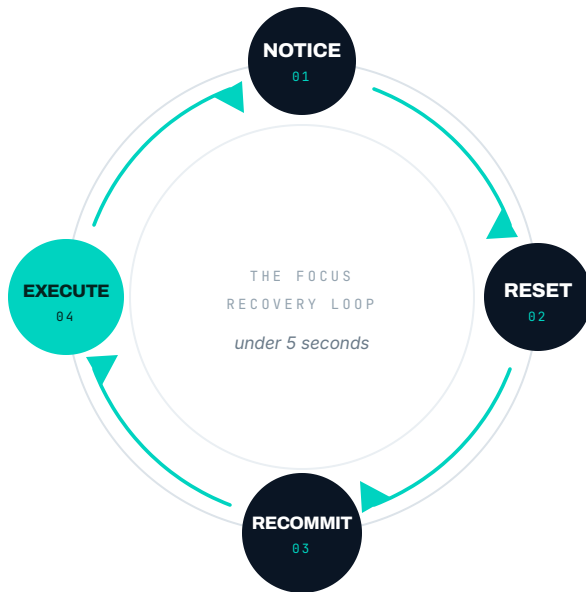
Run a two-week maintenance cycle: three sessions a week, one clean, one external load, one pressure. Retest the Baseline Ten monthly. The routine decays if it is never rehearsed in a quiet setting — hold onto the bottom rung.

NEUROVISION EDGE

Fourteen days will tell you whether your attention holds. Measuring *why* — tracking, depth, peripheral awareness, reaction speed — is what structured visual performance testing is for.

THE PROTOCOL

WHEN YOU LOSE FOCUS



You will lose it. Everyone does, including the people you watch on television. What separates them is not that it happens less often — it is that **the return is rehearsed.**

01 NOTICE

Name it, silently and neutrally: *"noise"*, *"movement"*, *"thought"*. Naming it converts an ambush into information. The players who struggle are the ones who only notice the distraction after the ball has already missed.

02 RESET

Physically step off. Back from the ball, one breath out, hands off the grip. A mental reset without a physical one rarely holds — your body needs to leave the address position for the routine to genuinely start again.

03 RECOMMIT

Say the line and the speed again — the same four words as before. You are not re-reading the putt. You are re-signing the decision you already made, so that QUIET has something settled to sit on.

04 EXECUTE

Full routine from SET. Three looks, fixation, stroke, dwell. Not a rushed version because you have already taken longer than you wanted — the same version.

THE CUE

**NOTICE IT.
STEOFF.
SAY IT AGAIN.
SEE. SET. QUIET. GO.**

✓ THE PART MOST GOLFERS GET WRONG

Getting annoyed about having been distracted. Frustration is a second distraction stacked on the first, and it lasts considerably longer than the noise did. Being interrupted is not a failure of concentration — **staying interrupted is.**

🕒 MAKE IT A MEASURED SKILL

Drill 08 exists specifically to train this loop, and your recovery time is a tracked number on the scorecard. Most golfers who commit to it get from twelve seconds and visible irritation down to under five and a shrug within two weeks.

PRINT THIS PAGE

PRE-SHOT CHECKLIST

Seven boxes. Run through them mentally on the practice green until they disappear into the routine and you no longer need the page.

- ☐ **I identified my target.**
One line, one speed — specific enough to say out loud in four words.
- ☐ **I committed to the shot.**
The decision is closed. If it is not, I step away rather than hoping.
- ☐ **My face is on the line and my body is on the face.**
Aim first, stance second. Never the other way round.
- ☐ **I took three looks at most, and the last one came back to the ball.**
A fourth look means restart, not "close enough".
- ☐ **My eyes settled on the ball before the club moved.**
Two to three seconds of stillness. The backswing begins underneath it.
- ☐ **I stopped adding information.**
No new reads, no swing thoughts, no re-checking the wind.
- ☐ **I executed, and my eyes stayed where the ball was.**
Hold the spot. Let your ears tell you the result first.

IF IT BREAKS • THE RESET

NOTICE → RESET → RECOMMIT → EXECUTE

Step off physically. One breath. Say the line and speed again. Then run the full routine — not a shortened apology for one.

CARRY THIS

**SEE IT.
SET IT.
QUIET.
GO.**

MY FOUR WORDS TODAY

LINE

SPEED

CUE WORD

FIXATION POINT

PRINT THIS PAGE

FOCUS SCORECARD

One row per session. Fill it in before you leave the green — scores written from memory that evening are guesses.

DATE	DRILL	LEVEL	PUTTS	SUCCESS	FOCUS 1-10	ROUTINE 1-10	RECOVERY SEC	NOTES

SESSION DEBRIEF

What distracted me?

How quickly did I recover?

Did my routine change under pressure — and how?

SCORING KEY

1-3

Attention was elsewhere for most of it

4-6

Came and went; several compromised putts

7-8

Mostly held; recovered quickly when it slipped

9-10

Held throughout, including under load

SCORE HONESTLY

A 6 you can trust is worth more than a 9 you awarded yourself for making putts. This column is about attention, not outcome.

PRINT THIS PAGE

14-DAY TRACKER

Plot two dots a day: your clean-block focus score and your loaded-block score. The gap between the lines is the thing you are training.



DAILY LOG

DAY	LEVEL	CLEAN	LOADED	ONE LINE ON WHAT HAPPENED
01				
02				
03				
04				
05				
06				
07				

DAY	LEVEL	CLEAN	LOADED	ONE LINE ON WHAT HAPPENED
08				
09				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

END-OF-PROGRAM REVIEW

Day 1 clean score vs Day 14 clean score — what moved?

Did the gap between clean and loaded narrow? By how much?

Which level do I repeat before moving on?

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Both lines drifting upward is nice. The lines **converging** is the result you came for — that is fragility under distraction going down.

FOR COACHES & PARENTS

RUNNING THE SYSTEM

Your job in this system is narrow and unusual: you are the source of the distraction and the recorder of the response. You are **not** coaching the stroke while any of this is happening.

HOW TO INTRODUCE DISTRACTION

- 01 **Explain it first.** The athlete should know distraction is coming, and why. Ambushing a player without consent builds resentment, not resilience.
- 02 **Start below what they can handle.** The first loaded session should be one they pass comfortably. Early success is what makes them willing to climb.
- 03 **Randomise the timing, not the intensity.** Unpredictability is the training stimulus. Escalating volume just makes the session unpleasant.
- 04 **Keep a clean block in every session.** Five putts before, three after. It gives you a within-session comparison and sends them home with the routine intact.
- 05 **Say what you are measuring before they start.** If they think you are counting makes, they will train for makes.

⚠ SAFETY, ETIQUETTE, CONSENT

Stay behind the player and outside the club's arc. Nothing thrown, nothing near the line of play. Do not run visual or auditory loading on a shared practice green — other golfers have not agreed to your session. Avoid strobing or flashing devices entirely where anyone present has a migraine or photosensitivity history.

WHAT TO WATCH – NOT THE BALL

OBSERVE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
HEAD	Does it stay down through and past contact, or lift with the stroke?
LOOKS	Count them. Three or fewer. A creeping fourth look is your earliest warning sign.
TEMPO	Time from address to takeaway. Compare loaded reps with clean ones.
STEP-OFFS	More step-offs is usually <i>progress</i> — they are catching problems earlier.
RECOVERY	Seconds from interruption to a rebuilt routine. Track it like a physical metric.
FACE	Irritation after a distraction means the load is above their current capacity.

✔ THE ONE QUESTION TO ASK

After a miss, ask "*where were your eyes?*" — never "*what did you do wrong?*" The first produces information you can both use. The second produces a technical theory that will be in their head on the next putt.

▮ WHAT PROGRESS ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

Not a higher make rate — over 10 to 20 putts that number is far too noisy to read. Progress is the **narrowing gap** between clean and loaded focus scores, and a falling recovery time.

WHAT NOT TO COACH DURING EXECUTION

DON'T SAY	SAY INSTEAD
"Keep your head still."	"Eyes on the dot until you hear it."
"Don't decelerate."	"Commit to the speed before you set up."
"Rotate through the ball."	"Roll it to the spot."
"Relax, don't be nervous."	"Same routine. Same tempo."
"You're getting quick."	"Two seconds over the ball."

The pattern is consistent: replace internal, body-focused instructions with external, target-focused ones. Research on attentional focus in golf repeatedly finds that an external focus produces better accuracy than an internal one — in beginners and experts, and under anxiety as well as calm conditions. Wulf & Su (2007); Bell & Hardy (2009).

⚠ THE OVERLOAD TRAP

One cue per session. If you are running distraction work and also fixing the stroke path and also mentioning grip pressure, you have become the cognitive load — and the athlete has no attention left for the thing you are supposedly training.

PRESSURE THAT BUILDS, PRESSURE THAT BREAKS

BUILDS

- Consequences the athlete chose
- Clear rules and a defined end point
- Difficulty they succeed at roughly 7 times in 10
- A debrief immediately afterwards
- Failure framed as data about the routine

BREAKS

- Consequences imposed on them
- Public comparison with teammates
- Difficulty they rarely beat
- Ending the session on a failure
- Any suggestion that missing means weak character

🔗 WORKING WITH JUNIOR GOLFERS

Cap Level 6 and 7 work at twice a week and never finish a session there — always return to a clean block so the last repetition of the day is a successful one. Let the athlete choose the consequence. And keep the debrief to two questions: *where were your eyes*, and *how long did the reset take*. Neither is about the result.

✅ A NOTE FOR PARENTS

The most useful thing you can do at a tournament is nothing visible. If your player has trained this system, they already have a routine and a reset. Asking about their score on the walk to the next tee is a Level 5 cognitive load they did not ask for.

🕒 A REALISTIC WEEKLY STRUCTURE

Three sessions of 15 minutes beats one session of 45. One clean, one external or cognitive load, one pressure. Retest the Baseline Ten monthly and keep the scorecards — the trend across two months is the only thing that reliably tells you it is working.

THE GOAL ISN'T PERFECT FOCUS.

Nobody holds unbroken attention for four and a half hours. The eighteenth green is loud, your playing partner is talking, and the number you need arrives in your head uninvited.

What you can build is a routine that is easy to return to and a return you have practised hundreds of times. That is all elite focus has ever been.

You now have the routine, the ladder, the drills and the scorecard. **Train your attention before pressure tests it.**

NOTICE



RESET



RECOMMIT



EXECUTE



SOURCES

REFERENCES

Every empirical claim in this guide traces to one of the works below. Where a finding rests on a small sample or a contested mechanism, that limitation is stated on the page where the claim appears rather than buried here.

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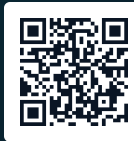
 SCOPE OF THIS GUIDE

This is a performance training resource, not medical advice, and it is not a substitute for a professional eye examination. If you experience blurred or double vision, eye strain, headaches or difficulty tracking a ball, see a qualified optometrist — a visual problem is not something a focus routine will fix.

YOUR VISION IS TRAINABLE.

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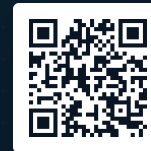
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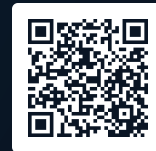
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